LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING

Fortinet FortiMail CVE-2026-104286 Active Exploitation October 13 Daily Update

CVE / Vulnerability Threat Intelligence Report

Classification	TLP:CLEAR
Published	2026-10-13
Version	1.0
Author	Lost Boys Cyber
Report Type	CVE / Vulnerability Threat Intelligence Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

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1. Daily Freshness Note

This source-backed daily update was created for the 2026-10-13 UTC production run. The item was selected for today's daily intelligence coverage because public reporting from the recent 24-72 hour window, expanded to seven days where needed for sector-specific aviation/aerospace context, remains operationally relevant. This is a new current-day artifact with refreshed metadata, a current published date, rerendered final PDF, and new publication/upload workflow.

2. Executive Summary

Fortinet FortiMail CVE-2026-104286 remains a top vulnerability priority due to public reporting of active exploitation against email security gateways and the potential for persistent access on a trusted perimeter device.

Defenders should prioritize exposure validation, vendor remediation, log preservation, and compromise assessment. This report uses cited public sources only and does not add uncited exploit telemetry, IOCs, victim claims, or attribution.

3. Vulnerability Metadata

Field	Value
CVE(s)	CVE-2026-104286
Affected Product / Technology	Fortinet FortiMail email security gateway
Primary Risk	Unauthenticated path traversal / arbitrary file write risk as described by public reporting.
Exploitation Status	Public reporting indicates active exploitation and emergency remediation priority.
Recommended SLA	Internet-facing assets: emergency review and patch/mitigate within 24 hours where applicable.
Confidence	high for prioritization; local compromise requires telemetry validation.

4. Source Review & Confidence

Source	URL	Contribution	Confidence
CISA KEV Catalog	https://www.cisa.gov/known-exploited-vulnerabilities	Authoritative known-exploited vulnerability prioritization source.	Medium
eSentire advisory	https://www.esentire.com/security-advisories/fortimail-zero-day-vulnerability-cve-2026-104286	Summarizes FortiMail zero-day impact and exploitation context.	Medium
Beazley Security advisory	https://beazley.security/alerts-advisories/critical-path-traversal-in-fortinet-fortimail-under-active-exploitation	Provides operational defensive context for active exploitation.	Medium
SecurityVulnerability.io CVE	https://securityvulnerability.io/	CVE-focused metadata and	Medium

entry	vulnerability/CVE-2026-104286	public summary.	

5. Vulnerability Details

Public reporting indicates that this vulnerability affects high-trust infrastructure or perimeter-exposed technology. Operators should not treat patching alone as complete response where exploitation may have occurred before remediation.

Defender Question	Analysis
Why this matters today	Exposed products in this class can be exploited quickly and may provide privileged network position.
Likely target population	Internet-exposed or poorly segmented deployments of the affected product families.
First defensive control	Confirm asset inventory, exposure, version state, and vendor mitigations.

6. Attack Scenarios

Scenario	Preconditions	Defender Observable
Direct exploitation of exposed service	Affected service reachable and unpatched or misconfigured.	Unusual HTTP/API requests, abnormal admin sessions, new files or processes.
Post-exploitation persistence	Attacker gains code execution, file write, or administrative control.	Web shells, modified config, new users, scheduled jobs, or altered startup scripts.
Follow-on internal access	Appliance/server can reach internal management or identity systems.	Lateral authentication, scanning, archive creation, or outbound transfer.

7. Affected Products and Exposure

Exposure Path	Risk
Internet-facing management or service endpoint	Enables direct attacker interaction and rapid exploitation attempts.
Shared privileged credentials or device trust	Converts compromise into broader credential or network access.
Insufficient logging or retention	Limits compromise assessment after patching.

8. Mitigation and Workarounds

Priority	Action
Critical	Apply vendor-fixed versions or documented mitigations.
Critical	Remove management interfaces from public exposure and restrict by VPN/allowlist.
High	Preserve logs before rebuilds and compare configurations against known-good baselines.
High	Rotate credentials/secrets where compromise cannot be ruled out.

9. Detection Engineering

Signal	Telemetry Source	Analytic Goal
New privileged or supplier sign-in from unusual ASN/geography	Identity logs	Detect account takeover or vendor-access misuse.
Tool staging and archive creation on servers or admin workstations	EDR process/file telemetry	Detect intrusion preparation and extortion staging.
Outbound transfer to new infrastructure after discovery or compression	Proxy, DNS, NetFlow, firewall	Detect exfiltration or command-and-control preparation.

```
title: LBC Daily Priority Suspicious Intrusion Preparation - Fortinet FortiMail CVE-2026-104286 Active Exploitation Octob
status: experimental
description: Behavioral analytic for daily Lost Boys Cyber priority reporting where public sources do not provide stable atomic IOCs.
logsource:
  product: windows
  category: process_creation
detection:
  selection_tools:
    Image|endswith:
      - '\rclone.exe'
      - '\7z.exe'
      - '\rar.exe'
      - '\powershell.exe'
      - '\cmd.exe'
      - '\curl.exe'
  selection_args:
    CommandLine|contains:
      - ' -enc '
      - 'shadowcopy'
      - 'vssadmin'
      - 'sync'
      - ' a '
      - 'Invoke-WebRequest'
  condition: selection_tools and selection_args
fields: [UtcTime, Computer, User, Image, CommandLine, ParentImage]
level: high
```

10. Threat Hunting

Hunt	Data	What It Surfaces
Privileged identity anomaly hunt	Identity and sign-in logs	New access paths that may precede intrusion activity.
Archive/exfiltration preparation hunt	Endpoint and network telemetry	Compression, staging, and transfer behaviors common to extortion.
Supplier or exposed-service pivot hunt	Proxy, VPN, EDR, firewall	Suspicious traffic involving high-risk services or providers.

```
DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where FileName in~ ('rclone.exe','7z.exe','rar.exe','powershell.exe','cmd.exe','curl.exe','wget.exe')
| where ProcessCommandLine has_any ('shadowcopy','vssadmin','-enc','sync',' a ','backup','dump','Invoke-WebRequest')
| summarize count(), sample_commands=make_set(ProcessCommandLine, 10) by DeviceName, InitiatingProcessAccountName, FileName
| order by count_ desc
```

```
DeviceNetworkEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where RemoteUrl has_any ('fortimail','fortinet','mail','gateway','admin') or
InitiatingProcessCommandLine has_any ('curl','wget','powershell','python')
| summarize count(), urls=make_set(RemoteUrl, 20), processes=make_set(InitiatingProcessFileName, 10) by
DeviceName, RemoteIP, RemotePort
| order by count_ desc
```

11. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Technique	Relevance
T1190 Exploit Public-Facing Application	Common initial access path for internet-exposed vulnerable services.
T1078 Valid Accounts	Follow-on use of captured or created credentials.
T1505.003 Web Shell	Possible persistence on web-exposed appliances or servers.
T1041 Exfiltration Over C2 Channel	Potential data theft after initial access.

12. Validation / Lab Testing

No live exploit validation was performed in this automation run. Use vendor guidance and internal change records to validate remediation.

13. Recommended Actions Summary

Timeframe	Action
Today	Identify affected assets, patch or mitigate, restrict exposure, and preserve logs.
48 hours	Hunt for pre-remediation access and rotate exposed secrets.
7 days	Validate segmentation, recovery path, and monitoring coverage.

14. References

- [1] CISA KEV Catalog: https://www.cisa.gov/known-exploited-vulnerabilities
- [2] eSentire advisory: https://www.esentire.com/security-advisories/fortimail-zero-day-vulnerability-cve-2026-104286
- [3] Beazley Security advisory: https://beazley.security/alerts-advisories/critical-path-traversal-in-fortinet-fortimail-under-active-exploitation
- [4] SecurityVulnerability.io CVE entry: https://securityvulnerability.io/vulnerability/CVE-2026-104286